

The cluster will house two-three shipyards along with a network of ancillary industries. According to officials, this development is expected to attract private investment of about ₹23,700 crore.

Further, to support this large-scale industrial ecosystem, common marine and land-based infrastructure worth around ₹3,300 crore will be developed.

According to industry body ASSOCHAM, Gujarat's position at the top of India's manufacturing and investment landscape is not the result of a single policy or one mega investment, but is the outcome of a long-term industrial model built around infrastructure, policy continuity, institutional facilitation and execution.

"Gujarat's ability to pre-develop industrial infrastructure such as the Special Investment Regions in Sanand, Dholera and GIFT City removes the friction of land acquisition and utility set-up for large-scale manufacturers," says Milan Thakkar, chairman, policy advocacy and ease of doing business committee, ASSOCHAM Gujarat Council.

The NITI Aayog's first Investment Friendliness Index released in 2026 uses a 100-point scale and serves as a benchmark for states to improve their investment environment. Five states—Gujarat, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Goa and Odisha—were identified as the top performers based on the scores. Among large states, Gujarat was identified as the best performer with a score of 56.6.

"The state's score is driven by its strong performance across infrastructure, business climate, financial health, regulatory ease and government policy pillars, with areas of improvement in resources, institutional environment and environment resilience pillars," ac-

THE STATE IN NUMBERS

+

56.6

Gujarat's score in NITI Aayog's Investment Friendliness ranking

+

23.8

Hours, the average per day power supply, which is 4% higher than the average of large states

+

31%

of India's merchandise exports are from Gujarat, nearly twice that of the next highest state

+

2.81%

Gujarat's fiscal deficit, the lowest among all states, as of FY2024

MANUFACTURING CHAMPIONS

cording to NITI Aayog.

It pointed out that Gujarat's high rank in infrastructure was the result of its efficient port operations; the turnaround time weighted by capacity for major and non-major ports was the lowest.

It also noted that Gujarat offered power to industrial users at prices 29% below the pan-India average. "Electricity downtime in the state is also low, with an average power supply of 23.8 hours a day (4% higher than the large state average), thus providing reliable and uninterrupted power supply to businesses."

Importantly, Gujarat also scored well on the financial health pillar. At 2.81%, it had the lowest fiscal deficit as a percentage of GSDP among the states, as of financial year 2024. Also, its outstanding liabilities as a percentage of GSDP remained sustainable at 18%, 40% below the average for the large states, it said.

In June 2026, the Gujarat government announced its new industrial policy. It's a holistic framework aimed at driving the next phase of growth. According to Chief Minister Patel, the policy has been designed with a future-oriented approach by incorporating the aspirations of industries, at a time when the rapidly evolving global economy, technological advancements, artificial intelligence, green energy, and the restructuring of global supply chains are transforming the industrial landscape.

The government wants to position Gujarat as a global hub for advanced manufacturing, research and development and value addition. It will provide support for micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) to scale rapidly and transition from small enterprises into strong, globally competitive businesses. There will also be enhanced assistance for start-ups and